

Growth, Water Scarcity, and Long-Term Supply In Nevada

WHAT THIS BRIEF IS ABOUT

This preliminary Legislative Brief is a NELIS-only package for internal Forum review. It organizes **147 unique water-related bills** identified in Nevada Electronic Legislative Information System (NELIS) title/summary search across the 2019, 2021, 2023, and 2025 regular sessions. [S4] Synthesis below describes **purpose cues and drafting language visible in bill titles**. It is not a deliberation guide and not the final OpenStates-enriched Version 0. Where NELIS discovery fields do not include a needed fact, this brief states **INSUFFICIENT DATA**.

KEY STATISTICS

147

Unique water-related bills in the NELIS search set across four sessions. [S4]

36

Bills in the 80th (2019) Regular Session search set. [S4]

33

Bills in the 81st (2021) Regular Session search set. [S4]

36

Bills in the 82nd (2023) Regular Session search set. [S4]

42

Bills in the 83rd (2025) Regular Session search set. [S4]

BILL THEMES AND DRAFTING LANGUAGE

Analyzer title-language clusters from verified NELIS bills. Outcomes (committee/floor/enactment) are **INSUFFICIENT DATA**. [S4]

Theme family	Bills in cluster	Illustrative bills	Purpose clue (title only)	Impact / outcome
General water statute revisions	28	AB30, AB51, AB62, AB95 (2019); AB19, AB20 (2023)	Amend existing water-law provisions rather than name a single program	INSUFFICIENT DATA
Groundwater basins & boards	7	SB140 (2019); SB149 (2021); SB112, SB113, SB176, SB180 (2023); AB363 (2025)	Change basin use, boards, assessments, management plans, or groundwater conservation	INSUFFICIENT DATA
Division of Water Resources appropriations	6	SB509 (2019); AB465 (2021); SB102, SB472, SB473 (2023)	Fund agency vehicles, systems, or related DWR operations	INSUFFICIENT DATA
Water rights, diversion, dedication	5	SB236, SB250 (2019); AB6 (2021)	Adjust diversion, dedication, or temporary change of appropriated water	INSUFFICIENT DATA
Water conservation	4	AB163 (2019); AB191, AB220 (2023); AB134 (2025)	Revise or establish water-conservation provisions	INSUFFICIENT DATA
Colorado River institutions	3	SB76 (2019); AB15 (2021); SJR3 (2023)	Change CRC services/membership or memorialize a Reclamation request	INSUFFICIENT DATA
Planning / drought / studies	2	SB499 (2019); AB265 (2019)	Create advisory drought/planning capacity or commission a treatment/recycling study	INSUFFICIENT DATA

STATE OF PLAY

Agency context materials describe Southern Nevada supply dependence on the Colorado River system and an ongoing state water-planning function. [S1][S2] Across four sessions,

INSUFFICIENT DATA for committee votes, floor votes, crossover, second-chamber action, individual yeas/nays, sponsors/cosponsors, or signed-into-law outcomes. [S4]

NELIS search shows a steady cadence of water-tagged filings (36, 33, 36, then 42 in 2025). [S4]

Title language repeatedly returns to general water-statute revision, groundwater instruments, rights administration, conservation, Colorado River institutions, and DWR capacity. [S4]

An LCB data-centers background memo is included as growth/large-user context; it does not identify which of the 147 bills passed. [S3]

HOW THIS WORKS IN NEVADA (INSTITUTIONS NAMED IN SOURCES)

Collected materials place water administration with the Division of Water Resources / State Engineer under Nevada water statutes (including NRS Chapters 533 and 534 as linked in this package). [S1][S10][S11] Southern Nevada supply framing appears in SNWA public materials. [S2] Bill titles additionally name the Colorado River Commission of Nevada and, in SJR3 (2023), the U.S. Bureau of Reclamation. [S4]

WHAT IS CURRENTLY BEING INTRODUCED (FROM NELIS TITLES)

Conservation and general water statute work. Twenty-eight titles use stock “revises provisions ... water” language; four titles expressly address water conservation. [S4]

Groundwater management. Seven titles name basins, boards, assessments, management plans, or groundwater conservation across 2019–2025. [S4]

Colorado River / CRC interface. CRC service and membership measures plus a 2023 Reclamation-focused joint resolution. [S4]

Rights and agency capacity. Diversion/dedication/temporary-change titles, plus multiple DWR appropriations. [S4]

ASSEMBLY VIABILITY INDICATORS (PRELIMINARY)

Historically, bills on groundwater, water rights, conservation, and Colorado River institutions have appeared across multiple recent Nevada sessions. [S4] Enacted legislation rates and bipartisan sponsorship are **INSUFFICIENT DATA** in this export. Data gaps prevent assessment of committee and floor survivorship.

KEY DATA GAPS

- Committee votes (origin chamber)
- Floor votes (origin chamber)
- Crossover and second-chamber committee/floor votes
- Individual yes/no/other votes
- Primary sponsors and cosponsors
- Signed-into-law / chapter / veto outcomes
- Twenty-year enacted-policy impact analysis
- Full bill digests beyond NELIS title lines

SELECTED SOURCES

S sources are public materials. Chicago bibliography form, keyed like Phase 2 Issue Brief style. Phase 2 Issue Brief v1.5 is a format reference only, not a legislative-outcome source.

[S1] Nevada Division of Water Resources. “Water Planning.” *Nevada Division of Water Resources*. Accessed July 13, 2026. <https://water.nv.gov/programs/water-planning>.

[S2] Southern Nevada Water Authority. “Where Your Water Comes From.” *Southern Nevada Water Authority*. Accessed July 13, 2026. <https://www.snwa.com/water-resources/where-water-comes-from/>.

[S3] Nevada Legislative Counsel Bureau. *Data Centers Background Information*. Interim committee document no. 32531. Nevada Legislature. <https://www.leg.state.nv.us/App/InterimCommittee/REL/Document/32531>.

[S4] Nevada Legislature. Nevada Electronic Legislative Information System (NELIS). Bill search compilation for the 80th–83rd Regular Sessions, water-related measures. Accessed July 13, 2026. <https://www.leg.state.nv.us/App/NELIS/>. See Appendix A.

[S10] Nevada Revised Statutes Chapter 533. <https://www.leg.state.nv.us/NRS/NRS-533.html>.

[S11] Nevada Revised Statutes Chapter 534. <https://www.leg.state.nv.us/NRS/NRS-534.html>.

